

Area of Study 4: Religious Music of the Baroque Period

Outline	Learners should study how vocal music was used to express religious belief in the Baroque period: • study examples in depth of sacred vocal music from the period of study, using live performances, recordings and scores as appropriate • use attentive listening and contextual knowledge to analyse, evaluate and make critical judgements about the repertoire • use technical vocabulary to communicate a sophisticated understanding of Baroque religious music and its context.
Focus for learning	Learners should analyse, explain and compare developments in religious music style, including: • Catholic tradition in Italy, e.g. Venetian concertato, a cappella successors to Palestrina, Latin oratorio, operatic influence on vernacular oratorio • Lutheran and Catholic Germany, e.g. Chorale, Venetian influence, passion music, chorale, church cantata, recitative, aria, chorus • Anglican developments, motet, English oratorio • French grand motet, solo petit motet, cantata, choral style. Learners should study and understand how composers use musical elements, including: • harmony and tonality • structures, e.g. recitative, aria, chorus • textures e.g. chordal, fugal, imitative, solo and choral writing, instrumental • word setting and interpretation of text • resources, accompaniment e.g. obbligato • rhythm and metre, e.g. from dance patterns. Learners should study and understand the conditions and context in which religious music of the period was created and performed, including: • worship, liturgy, opportunities and restrictions, e.g. Lent, Holy Week, use of instruments in church, use of Latin or vernacular • dissemination of music, e.g. publishing • working conditions for church musicians, education and training, e.g. St Mark's Venice, Chapel Royal, St Thomas's Leipzig.
Prescribed works	No prescribed works for this Area of Study.
Suggested repertoire	A list of suggested repertoire is provided (see appendix 5e).